

Don't believe me? In the book *Hooked: How to build habit-forming products*, authors Nir Eyal and Ryan Hoover write, 'A habit is at work when users feel a tad bored and instantly open Twitter. They feel a pang of loneliness and before rational thought occurs, they are scrolling through their Facebook feeds. A question comes to mind and before searching their brains, they query Google. The first-to-mind solution wins. In [chapter 1](#) of this book, we explore the competitive advantages of habit-forming products.' Now, the authors used the word 'habit-forming', but you could easily substitute the word 'addictive'.

When we think of our Money Environment, it's important to understand some companies are setting us up to financially fail by forming habit-forming or addictive products and technology. And it's important to design an environment so you don't fall victim to that.

One of the reasons it was so important for me to include a chapter on addiction and compulsion in this book is because of my own family history. Throughout the generations in my family there are patterns of addiction and compulsion that have manifested in alcoholism, drug abuse, eating disorders, burnout and more.

Personally, I am prone to compulsive behaviour. I have been diagnosed in the past with PTSD and still need to manage the symptoms of that in my day to day life. Otherwise, when I'm stressed, they can manifest in obsessive compulsive type behaviour. This behaviour includes an inability to cope with sound, light and touch, and results in behaviour that tries desperately to control my exposure to these things. As I mentioned in [chapter 14](#), I have a toolkit that I use to manage my stress level because I know if I don't it will result in financially sabotaging, compulsive behaviour as a way to regain some type of control. Which of course, as I described back in [chapter 14](#), has quite the opposite effect.

But it's only by owning this part of my life—as messy and uncomfortable as it is—that I'm able to do something about it. It's only by understanding how I behave and my inclinations and by creating an environment that's right for me that I'm able to limit the effects PTSD and the related compulsive behaviours have on both my life and my finances.

Now, if I can publicly state and own this—someone who is supposed to be naturally good with money—surely you can too. But acknowledging that I'm susceptible to compulsive behaviour that can be problematic for